

the battery and how to record the data; everything is done through the Hygge Box. AI then identifies the maximum carbon-intensive application, and it allocates that unit of renewable generation to that application.

“Hygge’s patents are all about how we track renewable generation, how we ensure and track where it has been consumed, and then how it is getting converted into carbon

credits,” says Prateek.

It is just a matter of accounting, tracking, and allocating. And if you can do it in a proper auditable way, then that is approved by the UN for carbon credit calculation. So that’s what the Hygge platform does. The artificial intelligence and the company’s unique way of using blockchain nodes embedded within the Hygge Box is an innovative way to reduce energy consumption and

maximise profit for the users.

Prateek says, “Blockchain technology is considered a very energy-intensive technology. And hence we went for a pattern which is unique, which is low energy intensive blockchain technology, which is embedded on Hygge Box, which is an IoT box, and not on Cloud. We are probably one of the first few startups capable of doing it.”

—Sharad Bhowmick

2 THE TALE OF DRONE AND DHANDHA

Two boys from Odisha, bored with their engineering curriculum, ventured out to build a rocket during their college days and got appreciated by Prime Minister Modi in his *Mann Ki Baat*. They are now providing enterprise drone solutions under the banner of IG Drones, with a remarkable business model directed by the motto ‘Every Home, One Drone!’ And as if that was not enough, their ‘big aim’ is to upskill one million Indian youth with the latest drone tech

A typical drone has three important components: frame, motors, and microcontroller. Our country has a mature carbon fibre or composite material industry, hence replicating frames is not a problem. Brushless direct current motor (BLDC) manufacturing is also blooming in India and, with some R&D, we will be able to replicate the drone motor building soon. The challenge is the brain of the drone, that is, the control board based on a microcontroller. “We are indigenously developing our flight controller, with our own software,” says Bodhisattwa Sanghapriya, founder and CEO of IG Drones.

The electrical and electronics engineers and the founders of Invent Grid (IG) Pvt Ltd, Bodhisattwa and Om Prakash, endeavored with Project VSLV (VSSUT Satellite Launching Vehicle), which was India’s first multipurpose student rocketry mission. After the Prime Minister Modi’s recognition, ISRO took over



Bodhisattwa Sanghapriya, founder and CEO of IG Drones, welcoming Prime Minister Modi at the IG Drones stall at Defence Expo-22 in Gandhinagar, Gujarat

the project. But the boys had found their way. They had gained crucial experience in building that rocket while gathering, processing, and analysing geospatial data. They realised that “the data is the game.”

Though they started as a software company, soon after the import ban on Chinese drones in

2020, they ventured out for hardware production amid its acute shortage in the market. Aimed at being a pan-India venture ever since the beginning, the founders faced the common stereotype, that people in the hardcore coding domain often lack business acumen.

“We took it as a challenge and